

Q.3c (15 marks): Victor Turner vs Clifford Geertz on performative aspects in rituals

3. (c)

अनुष्ठाना में प्रदर्शनात्मक पहलुओं का अध्ययन के लिए विक्टर टर्नर और क्लिफोर्ड गीर्ट्ज़ के दृष्टिकोण में अंतर पर चर्चा कीजिए।

Discuss the difference in approach of Victor Turner and Clifford Geertz to the study of performative aspects in rituals.

15

इस हशिप में नहीं लिखना चाहिए
Candidates must not write on this margin

Victor Turner and Clifford Geertz are associated with Symbolic and Interpretative school of Anthropology.

DIFFERENCES IN THEIR APPROACHES TO STUDY OF PERFORMATIVE ASPECTS IN RITUALS

(I) VICTOR TURNER'S APPROACH ÷

1) Social Order is maintained through rituals which in turn are governed by symbols. Thus

Symbols = "Operators in the Rituals"

2) Symbols



Arrangement and meaning



Rituals



Social Transformation

- (i) Tie individual to norms of Society
- (ii) Change individual Status
- (iii) Resolves Conflicts

3) Study ÷

Ndembu of Zambia in book "Forest of Symbols"

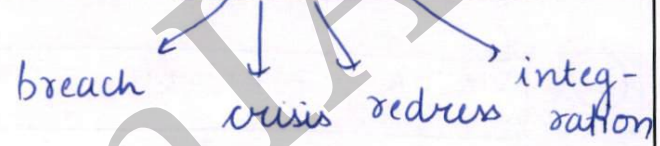
→ Ritual of feeding the milk sap from Mudyi tree to the child.

Mudyi tree → symbol of breast

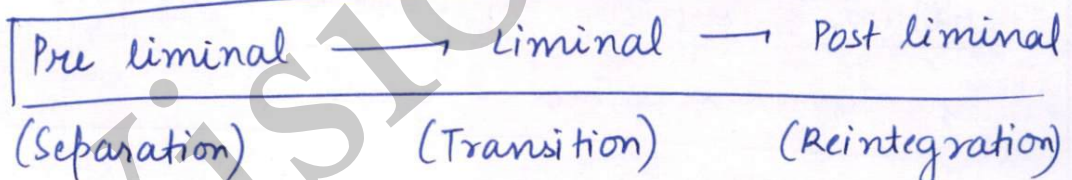
Sap → symbol of milk.

Ritual → reflects mother child bond.

4) Social drama involves rituals like



5) Rites of Passage involve 3 stages:



↑
Liminal stage marked

by a feeling of solidarity → "Communitas"

II CLIFFORD GEERTZ APPROACH

1) Interpretative approach → viewing the ritual from "Emic view" i.e. native's point of view.

2) Thick description

eg Wink → thin description — closing and opening of eye
→ thick description — whether it is a sign of flirtation or conspiracy.

3) Study :-

- Mourning Ritual among Japanese
↳ different symbols carry a specific meaning.
- Deep Play: A Note on Balinese Cockfight → This ritual depicts the already prevalent social tensions and competition.

#

SOME SIMILARITIES TOO

- 1) Both refer to Rituals as the sum of symbols.
- 2) "Emic view" is the focus of both.

Thus, Victor Turner and Geertz provided transformative insights into the performative aspects of various rituals.